CONTROLLED RESEARCH / APPROVAL PREPARATION / S04 + V01

PSS Acceptance 360 Master Research, Validation & Feasibility Terms of Reference

Programme charter • research protocol • hypothesis tests • feasibility methodology • evidence controls • Executive Committee gates

Prepared as a management proposal for the Research, Product & Business Development Division and PSS Executive Committee. 18 October 2026 | Version 1.0 | CONFIDENTIAL

CONTROL FIELD	PROPOSED RECORD
Document identifier	PSS-A360-S04-V01-TOR-001
Current status	Draft for management review; no evidence of formal PSS approval
Sponsor / decision body	CEO / Executive Committee — to be nominated and confirmed
Programme coordinator	Research, Product & Business Development Division — proposed
Legal / Finance / Technology / Risk	Review and approval roles proposed, not confirmed
Decision requested	90-day bounded research, validation and feasibility mandate, subject to priced budget and data-access safeguards
Day 0 definition	Date of recorded Executive Committee authorisation; no schedule commences automatically
Companion working register	PSS_A360_Master_Control_and_Evidence_Registers.xlsx
Supersession rule	No previous 2026 Last-Mile / Acceptance 360 draft is an approved investment case

Decision principle

The programme must prove four independent conditions before requesting pilot-build investment: (1) a bank buyer with economically credible terms; (2) measurable improvement against a realistic alternative; (3) lawful, secure, interoperable delivery within PSS and bank permissions; and (4) acceptable PSS and sponsor-bank economics. Failure of any critical condition is a legitimate recommendation to stop, narrow or defer the model.

Evidence basis: user-supplied Last-Mile Volume 1 (provided Parts A–B7 only); previous PSS Acceptance 360 strategic redesign and pre-feasibility analysis; and selected regulator, PCI and public company sources listed in §17. PSS internal primary records, regulator-specific approvals, bank contracts, fieldwork and management signatures have not been supplied or verified.

1 Mandate, purpose and decision boundary

Purpose. Specify the work required to assess whether PSS Acceptance 360 should be a bank-sponsored, modular merchant acceptance and merchant-operations infrastructure service, and if so, which subset should be offered first. This document commissions no live pilot, software build, procurement commitment or customer-funds activity.

Working design hypothesis. Evaluate four prospective service groups: Accept (eligible SoftPOS/POS and permitted interoperable QR presentation), Connect (bank and rail integrations), Operate (transaction status, exceptions, reconciliation, merchant support), and Grow (merchant reporting and additional services). PSS Secure remains a distinct card-not-present authentication product; PSS Trading is a potential supplier to be independently compared.

1.1 Decisions the study must enable

1. Should PSS invest in the full modular model, a narrower Operate + Connect proposition, targeted PSS Pay extension, a partnership-led solution, or no new platform?
2. Which licensed entity performs every regulated function, and what agreements and certifications are required before development or pilot?
3. Which bank is willing and able to pay, at what price and for what measurable benefit?
4. What is the prudent funding envelope for any subsequent proof of concept or live pilot, and what separate approvals are required?

1.2 In scope

- PSS current-state product, licence, architecture and security baseline; bank needs, current practices and counterfactuals.
- Market segmentation, bank and merchant qualitative discovery, competitive benchmarking, adoption and device-readiness tests.
- Regulatory, scheme, cybersecurity, data-protection, consumer-protection and outsourcing diligence.
- Economic buyer and willingness-to-pay interviews, indicative terms, bank-and-PSS unit economics, independent commercial challenge.
- Build / buy / partner alternatives, solution and operating-model design, staged pilot concept and capital budgeting.

1.3 Explicitly out of scope until separately approved

- Launching a national agent network, duplicating EthSwitch scheme infrastructure or changing national QR rules.
- Handling or safeguarding customer deposits, lending, independent KYC approval or settlement authority not expressly permitted by applicable licences.
- Executing binding bank/vendor contracts, widening production access, enrolling live merchants or making public product-launch announcements.
- Representing a draft NBE policy proposal, possible subsidy, future MDR or interchange reform as enacted or monetisable income.

2 Research questions and measurable end-products

RESEARCH QUESTION	ACCEPTANCE OUTPUT
RQ01 Strategy & alternatives	Comparative option case incl. do-nothing baseline, evidence and strategic rationale.
RQ02 PSS actual assets	Signed capability map: existing / contract-dependent / requires upgrade / unavailable.
RQ03 Bank buyer & price	Sponsor bank evidence, economic buyer, procurement path, nonbinding commercial terms and counterfactual.
RQ04 Merchant usefulness	Segment-level use cases, observed operational needs, device and connectivity findings.

RESEARCH QUESTION	ACCEPTANCE OUTPUT
RQ05 Legal and operating role	Responsibility matrix plus written regulatory/certification position and issue disposition.
RQ06 Technology feasibility	Security/architecture options, integration estimate, representative failure-mode tests.
RQ07 Financial investment case	Auditable 36-month monthly PSS and bank models, sensitivities and downside liquidity.
RQ08 Delivery & pilot gate	Costed pilot options, controls, evaluation protocol and independent go/revise/defer/stop recommendation.

3 Alternatives that must be assessed

OPTION	TEST / EXPECTED ADVANTAGE	POSSIBLE REJECTION REASON
A Full Acceptance 360	Reuse PSS assets; broaden products and contracting.	Bank will not fund breadth / high integration and service cost.
B Operate + Connect first	Payment status, reconciliation, exceptions and adapters.	Banks already obtain comparable service at lower incremental cost.
C PSS Pay / POS focus	Capitalise on existing acceptance product.	NFC distribution or per-merchant costs undermine activity.
D Partner-led orchestration	Reduce new development via existing rail/provider partnerships.	Insufficient differentiation or weak commercial control.
E No new investment	Continue existing lines; preserve resources.	Opportunity cost outweighs prudent development case.

No alternative is declared the winner at programme commencement. Option rankings require evidence-backed criteria, a documented scoring method and a sensitivity test; no subjective score is a substitute for sponsor contracts or compliance.

4 Evidence classification and decision-grade standards

LABEL	USE IN THIS PROGRAMME
E-PUB	Public primary/regulator source verified on stated access date; scope and effective status preserved.
E-REP	Public company statement or media report; not independently verified by PSS records.
E-INT	PSS internal system, ledger, licence, contract or financial evidence approved for controlled review.
E-FLD	Documented field interview/observation/test; consent and sampling limitations recorded.
E-COM	Written bank buyer price/terms evidence or duly authorised indicative commitment.
A-MOD	Model assumption or calculated scenario; not a discovered or approved price.
H-OPEN	Hypothesis / untested assertion; may not be represented as a conclusion.
G-BLOCK	Critical unresolved compliance, security, economic or contractual gate blocker.

Evidence rule: each material assertion gets an ID, source owner, file or URL, date, scope, corroboration, reviewer and specific decision use. Conflicting evidence must be logged rather than silently averaged or corrected. Sensitive records belong in access-restricted bank/PSS repositories; the shared register should store references, not raw personal data.

5 Research methodology and sampling

5.1 Workstream A — Current-state audit (Days 1–30)

Obtain documentary proof and, where authorised, operational walkthroughs for PSS Pay, gateway, POS, switching, 3-D Secure, merchant operations, PSS Trading supplier role, architecture, bank adapters, customer

support, settlement reports, and per-product P&L. Capture actual current certification, licence annexes, scheme conditions and contract scope. Apply a four-state capability label: demonstrated / internally documented / reported publicly / proposed.

5.2 Workstream B — Bank economic-buyer validation (Days 20–60)

Target approximately 4–6 purposively selected regulated-bank stakeholders, including shareholder and eligible non-shareholder perspectives where possible. Confirm decision authority and procurement path before considering opinions as buying intent. Separate problem interviews from pricing interviews. Seek at least one authorised lead-bank sponsor and nonbinding terms; the count is a research target, not an approved performance threshold.

Required evidence: existing acceptance costs, transaction/merchant exception load, merchant attrition and service constraints; target segment; service expectations and integration risk; price corridor for setup, contracted monthly minimum, operations service and usage fees; decision timetable; written alternative costs; ability to test in a permitted environment.

5.3 Workstream C — Merchant task and adoption validation (Days 25–60)

Use approximately 30–50 purposively selected merchants across contrasting business types, device conditions and locations, with one proposed primary pilot cluster and a research-only comparator. Conduct structured workflow observations and prototype/service-concept tests. Do not claim statistical representativeness; if TAM/adoption estimates are needed, design a separate probability sample or use documented administrative baselines.

Capture payment mix, time to confirm funds, reversals, mobile/internet access, NFC/QR eligibility, daily use frequency, costs, receipts, failed transaction consequences, trust, complaints and willingness to switch. Record small-merchant inclusion constraints without confusing registrations with recurring activity.

5.4 Workstream D — Technical and operational tests (Days 25–75)

Prepare a thin-slice prototype specification or isolated non-production test plan, subject to separate technical authorisation. Test duplicate calls/idempotency, false-success display, timeout/unknown status, reversals/refunds, bank reconciliation variance, payment rail outage, agent/support escalation, clock drift, disconnected devices, credential compromise and merchant data segregation. No real payment data or live funds flows without legal and technical approval.

5.5 Workstream E — Finance, regulatory and independent challenge (Days 45–90)

Finance reconciles model inputs to records and bank price evidence; Legal and Compliance map licences, scheme obligations, outsourcing and consumer protection; Risk/CISO independently challenge security and operating assumptions; an independent reviewer records dissent and corrective actions.

6 Testable hypotheses and falsification conditions

ID	HYPOTHESIS	DISCONFIRMING / DECISION EVIDENCE
H01	Bank operations and exception resolution are a funded pain point.	No identifiable bank budget owner, existing service performs equally, or no viable price.
H02	An Operate + Connect service is cheaper than bank stand-alone build/extension.	Actual bank counterfactual has lower total cost or superior service.
H03	PSS Pay/SoftPOS enables usable acceptance for chosen merchants.	Device/certification constraints, failure rate or activation economics make it infeasible.
H04	Adapters can be repeatable, tenant-isolated and reasonably priced.	Second bank still requires costly custom integration or fails segregation tests.
H05	Trusted rail status can drive correct merchant confirmations.	Unknown/pending treated as success, untraceable reversals, or reconciliation gaps.

ID	HYPOTHESIS	DISCONFIRMING / DECISION EVIDENCE
H06	At least one bank accepts a sustainable contracted pricing structure.	Sponsor declines economic terms or procurement path is non-credible.
H07	PSS and bank economics both work in downside-tolerant scenarios.	Unfunded fixed cost, negative sustainable unit margin or unacceptable liquidity.
H08	All proposed roles are legal and correctly certified.	Licence/scheme/security/data authority gap cannot be mitigated before pilot.
H09	Target merchants show repeat-use value rather than passive registration.	No observed recurring use case, excessive support cost or channel mismatch.
H10	PSS can avoid duplicating national rails or agent infrastructure.	Architecture requires prohibited parallel scheme functions or uncontracted access.
H11	Supplier arrangement, including any PSS Trading work, is governable.	Related-party terms, IP, audit or procurement conflicts cannot be resolved.
H12	A controlled pilot can be evaluated against pre-registered stop criteria.	No reliable cohort, metrics, independent data source or kill-switch owner.

The companion workbook maps these hypotheses to minimum proof, owners, source requests, status and gate consequences. A failed hypothesis is not automatically a failure of every option: recommend a narrower proposition where supported.

7 Primary data-request specification

REQUEST CLASS	MINIMUM DOCUMENTS / DATA	REVIEW OWNER
Licences and authorisations	NBE licence originals, annexes, conditions; regulator correspondence; bank/scheme permissions.	Legal / Compliance
Security and PCI	Current PCI DSS AOC and scope; mobile acceptance solution listing, scheme letters, device controls.	CISO / Security
PSS Pay operations	Monthly merchants/cohorts, transaction counts, success/failure/pending, refunds, devices, support, fraud.	Product / Operations
Gateway / switching	Product route map, integration inventory, transaction outcome traces and SLAs.	Technology / Operations
Financial baseline	CAPEX/OPEX, supplier contracts, licence fees, support costs, staff allocation, bank pricing, tax assumptions.	CFO / Finance
Bank merchant operations	Current merchant base, acceptance costs, complaint cases, reconciliation ageing, attrition, willingness to pay.	Sponsor-bank liaison
Governance and privacy	Data processing terms, lawful-basis assessment, retention, roles, risk and procurement policies.	Legal / DPO / Procurement

Data handling: request aggregate and redacted information by default. Any transaction-level or personal data access requires a written purpose, documented lawful basis, access approvals, defined retention, encryption, logging and bank/PSS controller–processor allocation. No unrestricted transfer into research spreadsheets or external AI tools.

8 Legal, regulatory and technical verification schedule

ISSUE	EXTERNAL BASELINE	INTERNAL CONFIRMATION REQUIRED
NDPS 2026–2030	NBE site labels published document as draft [SRC02].	Check final adoption, circulars, timing and operative QR/MDR rules as of review date.
PSS operator authority	NBE register lists PSS switch licence PSO/001/2013 [SRC03]; newer licences publicly reported [SRC04].	Original POS/gateway licence numbers, effective conditions, operating limits and NBE correspondence.

ISSUE	EXTERNAL BASELINE	INTERNAL CONFIRMATION REQUIRED
Mobile acceptance	PCI SSC describes MPoC as relevant to COTS acceptance [SRC05].	Exact PSS Pay listed configuration or applicable certification path, device controls, schemes.
Personal data	Proclamation 1321/2024 is in force [SRC06].	Legal assessment of consent/other lawful basis, roles, restrictions, security and transfers.
Rail integration	NBE draft describes national interoperable infrastructure and PSS private-switch role [SRC02].	Actual EthSwitch/bank interoperability agreements, IP, settlement and message rights.
Acquiring and claims	Bank and provider announcements are not licence substitutes.	Merchant agreement, disputes/refunds, chargeback, support liability and consumer notices.

9 Financial and commercial feasibility specification

Build separate but linked PSS and sponsor-bank investment models. Minimum horizon is monthly 36 months; optional annualised years 4–5. Include net-of-tax cash flow where the assumptions are available, setup and maintenance CAPEX, working capital, inflation, FX for imported services, staff and fraud/support cost, depreciation, funding, tax and discount rate. Every variable must show source, owner, confidence and effective date.

MODEL BLOCK	REQUIRED OUTPUT
Demand / cohort engine	Bank onboarding, merchant eligible/activated/30-day repeat-active, transaction frequency, channel mix, failure/reversal.
Contracted revenue	Setup fee, bank monthly floor, module fees, eligible processing charges; no uncontracted subsidy/MDR/interchange in base case.
Unit cost and cost-to-serve	Acquisition, integration, certification, hosting/security, dispute handling, support, bank servicing and merchant servicing.
Bank economic case	Bank baseline TCO, prospective savings/retention/volumes, fees paid to PSS, switching costs and transition risk.
PSS investment case	Monthly P&L, cash flow, capital, NPV/IRR (if meaningful), break-even date, maximum cash exposure and payback.
Downside stress	No subsidy, 50% slower bank activation, low merchant repeat use, price compression, 30% cost overrun, FX shock.
Decision sensitivity	Breakeven fee/merchant active volume/bank count, margin per transaction and largest profitability drivers.

All scenario shocks above are design exercises, not forecasts or agreed stress parameters. Finance must approve the actual ranges and benchmark the discount rate to PSS funding, risk and capital policy. Report cases where IRR is not defined or where no meaningful break-even occurs. Never infer bank willingness to pay from the pricing required to make NPV positive.

10 Feasibility report content and independent sign-off

5. Executive conclusion with clear recommendation (go, narrow, defer or stop) and explicit exclusions.
6. Market/customer proof including pricing letters and bank decision authority.
7. Current-state capability baseline and build/buy/partner option comparison.
8. Legal, security, scheme, operations and data-protection position with residual risks.
9. 36-month PSS and bank financial statements, sensitivities, sources and reconciliations.
10. Alternative comparison against no investment; quantified opportunity costs and key non-financial trade-offs.
11. Proposed one-cluster pilot charter, pre-registered metrics, consumer safeguards, spend ceiling and stage gates.
12. Independent Risk and Finance challenge records, signed functional reviews, unresolved disagreements and documented management response.

Quality standard: an internal report is not “independently validated” because its author marks it reviewed. The CFO, Legal/Compliance and Risk/CISO must sign or expressly record reservations; material feasibility gaps must appear in the one-page executive dashboard.

11 Delivery workplan and stage-gate sequencing

WINDOW FROM DAY 0	PRIMARY WORK	FORMAL OUTPUT / CONTROL
D00–D15	Mandate, charter, confidentiality, evidence room, requests, register and budget validation.	Authorised ToR, owner list, data access matrix; no unauthorised spend.
D16–D30	PSS capability/licence/PCI and cost baseline; bank pipeline and merchant sampling.	Capability map + initial red-flag log; CFO budget line review.
D31–D60	Buyer problem/value interviews, merchant workflows, architecture and supplier options.	Market evidence memo, bank price corridor and hypotheses review.
D61–D80	Legal/tech assurance, 36-month financial options, pilot architecture and costed plan.	F01 feasibility draft with all critical evidence linked.
D81–D90	Independent challenge, corrections, executive briefing and decision memo.	Gate 1 recommendation: STOP / NARROW / DEFER / AUTHORISE LIMITED PREPARATION.

Schedule dependency: Day 0 is an approved start, not 18 October 2026. Delayed bank access, licence verification or cost data triggers a documented scope reduction or revised timeline; it does not justify representing uncompleted work as validated.

12 Governance, accountability and challenge

ACCOUNTABLE ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	MANDATORY REVIEW
Executive Committee / CEO	Mandate, spending authority, sponsor nomination, independent gate decisions.	Initial mandate; Gate 1 decision and any extension.
RPB&D programme lead	Research plan, hypothesis management, interviews, product alternatives and synthesis.	Methodology, external engagement controls, traceability.
Finance / CFO	Budget certification, cost data, 36-month cash flow, bank/PSS economic analysis.	Sign financial model assumptions and capital request.
Technology & Operations	Capability inventory, integration blueprint, security cases, process and testing.	Architecture, feasibility estimates and operational owners.
Legal / Compliance / DPO	NBE licence scope, contracting, banking role, privacy, scheme/outsourcing position.	Written red-flag position and lawful data-access conditions.
Risk / CISO / Internal Audit	Independent control challenge, operational/IT risk, serious incident and assurance protocol.	Written dissent/remediation or formal clearance.
Procurement	Vendor alternatives, fair pricing, PSS Trading related-party controls.	Build-buy-partner integrity and contracting compliance.
Lead bank (prospective)	Business case, payments and merchant responsibilities, price evidence, pilot sponsorship.	Written sponsor intent and responsibility matrix if feasible.

No one function can waive a licence, security or data-protection blocker. Where reviewer opinions conflict, escalate the issue and append dissent to the investment memo. PSS Trading may bid for work; it does not automatically own development or certify its own procurement fairness.

13 Gate acceptance requirements

GATE	MINIMUM EVIDENCE	DECISION RULE
M0 Research mandate	Recorded resolution; named accountable staff; procurement-compliant estimate; lawful data-access plan.	Authorise research only, with CFO-confirmed ceiling; no live operations.
G1 Feasibility	Lead buyer terms/credible alternative, service advantage, validated product/licence/PCI path, signed model and risk challenge.	STOP / REDESIGN / DEFER / fund limited preparation subject to conditions.
G2 Live pilot readiness	Bank contracts, scheme/technical authority, test passes, final liability map, consumer terms, SLA, kill-switch and budget.	Separate ExCo authorisation for limited live pilot.
G3 Pilot evaluation	Independently measured cohort retention, safety/quality, reconciliation, disputes, bank value and unit economics.	Scale proposal only if the pre-agreed criteria and reviewer sign-offs hold.
G4 Commercial scale	Repeatable bank integration, sustainable contract revenue, capital, risk capacity and regulatory readiness.	Separate investment and geographic expansion decision.

13.1 Hard-stop and escalation triggers

- No authorised economic buyer and credible bank pricing evidence after the feasible research window (G1: narrow, defer or stop).
- No credible compliant way to operate within actual PSS licence, network/scheme and bank outsourcing conditions (G1/G2 blocker).
- Unknown/pending payments displayed as final successful payments; duplicate settlement/reversal risk; irreconcilable ledger differences (G2 blocker).
- Unmitigated critical security issue; invalid required certification; personal-data access without documented lawful authority (any-gate blocker).
- Pilot losses, complaints or service incidents breach predefined limits, or kill-switch responsibility is unclear (immediate stop/escalation).
- A base case dependent on undeclared future merchant fees, grant, rate reform, agent income or policy proposals (financial case failure).

14 Document architecture and deliverables

The 27-item register is the controlling inventory: Volume I S01–S04 (four), Volume II V01–V05 (five), Volume III F01–F06 (six), Volume IV P01–P04 (four), Volume V I01–I04 (four), and ExCo E01–E04 (four). S04 and the V01 research protocol are combined in this Master ToR but remain separate line items for traceability. The companion workbook identifies status, evidence prerequisites, primary owner, reviewer and gate.

Minimum initial mandate bundle: this S04/V01 document; its control workbook; an executive one-page mandate note (embedded in §16); and an agreed costed budget prepared by Finance. The remaining deliverables must be developed against incoming evidence, not pre-labelled “complete”.

15 Document controls and evidence room

13. File naming: PSS-A360-[CODE]-[descriptive-title]-vX.Y-[YYYYMMDD], with draft/approved status in metadata and cover.
14. Maintain one source register; one assumptions log; one gap register; one change/decision log; one linked hypotheses tracker; and one signed gate record.
15. Authoritative record hierarchy: law/regulator/contract/licence/internal system evidence; then quality-controlled field research; then company-reported/public statements; then analysis, hypotheses and historic drafts.

16. Apply document-level and data-level access restrictions. Publish only redacted management views; preserve raw bank and merchant data in approved repositories with retention rules.
17. Use separate “prepared by”, “reviewed by” and “approved by” fields; never auto-fill signatures. Freeze numbered evidence bundles at each gate.
18. Log amendments and contrary findings. Subsequent management reports must state which previous PSS Last-Mile or Acceptance 360 draft they supersede.

16 Proposed initial Executive Committee research mandate

RESOLUTION A — SCOPE. The Executive Committee may authorise the CEO to commission a maximum 90-day research, validation and feasibility assessment of PSS Acceptance 360 and narrower alternatives. Such authorisation is not endorsement of an approved product or national rollout.

RESOLUTION B — SPONSOR AND INFORMATION. The CEO may seek a lead-bank sponsor and appoint an accountable internal programme team. Any review of PSS and bank data is conditional on written data-sharing, confidentiality, privacy and security permissions.

RESOLUTION C — EXPENDITURE AND REVIEW. Finance shall present a separately itemised research budget and proposed cap for approval; no amount is assumed in this document. Binding vendor/technology contracts, live-merchant activity and pilot investment require subsequent separate approval. The programme lead reports at Days 30 and 60 and returns to the Committee with a Gate 1 recommendation.

Draft resolution wording is proposed for Legal / Company Secretary review and must follow PSS actual delegation-of-authority rules. This document does not claim the Executive Committee has approved, nominated or funded any of these actions.

17 Source, provenance and verification references

SRC01 PSS Last-Mile Acceptance Ecosystem Executive Document Package, Volume 1, 18 Oct 2026 | Internal source document | User-provided source; Parts A–B7 only. Earlier referenced Parts C–G not present in supplied file.

SRC02 National Bank of Ethiopia, Draft National Digital Payments Strategy 2026–2030 | NBE primary, draft status | https://nbe.gov.et/ndps/

SRC03 National Bank of Ethiopia, Payment Instrument Issuers/System Operators register | NBE primary; licence register snapshot subject to update | https://nbe.gov.et/payment-instrument-issuers-system-operators/

SRC04 Shega, Premier Switch Expands Into the Checkout, 30 Aug 2026 | News reporting of company announcements; not a licence copy | https://www.shega.co/news/premier-switch-expands-into-the-checkout-with-po-s-gateway-license

SRC05 PCI Security Standards Council, Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC) | Standard description; not PSS solution certification | https://www.pcisecuritystandards.org/standards/mobile-payments-on-cots-mpoc/

SRC06 Ethiopian Ministry of Justice, Personal Data Protection Proclamation 1321/2024 | Legal primary; specialist interpretation required | https://justice.gov.et/en/law/personal-data-protection-proclamation/

SRC07 PSS Acceptance 360 Strategic Redesign, v3, 18 Oct 2026 | Analytical antecedent | User-project analytical draft. Proposed design, not verified corporate strategy.

SRC08 PSS feasibility pack v2 and illustrative models, 18 Oct 2026 | Non-authoritative financial reference | User-project analytic drafts; no verified PSS bank-level actuals or signed audit.

SRC09 PCI SSC, MPoC solution listings | Certification lookup; requires exact product/provider/configuration | https://listings.pcisecuritystandards.org/assessors_and_solutions/mpoc_solutions?agree=true

Last external verification in this draft: 18 October 2026. Public registers and draft policies should be rechecked at execution, not treated as permanent conditions. Source PDFs and law must be reviewed by Legal for the operative terms.

18 Closure and recommended next controlled action

Management should first approve the ToR as a methodology, nominate owners and request PSS licence, product and financial source records. Finance should then attach a justified budget for the research programme. Only after those dependencies are met should the programme clock start. The correct deliverable at Day 90 is an honest investment decision, including a documented recommendation to stop if necessary—not an obligation to launch.